



MARY AND JIM RICKERT, who own the Prather Ranch, say an obvious solution is to allow cattle ranchers to shoot problem wolves.

Ranchers confront an old nemesis

SISKIYOU COUNTY, Calif. — In far Northern California, beneath a towering mountain ridge still covered in April snow, one of the state's last cowboys stood in the tall green grass of a pasture he tends, describing what he sees as the one blight on this otherwise perfect landscape: wolves.

"I hate 'em," said Joel Torres, 25, his easy smile fading as he explained what the apex predators do to the cattle in his care at Prather Ranch, an organic farm in Siskiyou County dedicated to raising beef in a natural, stress-free environment. "They've just been tearing into our baby calves, mostly our yearlings."

Unlike predators that go for the throat and kill

Despite efforts to push wolves toward deer and elk in California, the protected predators find cattle easier prey

By Jack Dolan

prey relatively quickly, wolves often attack from behind and rip victims apart while they're trying to flee. Once they bring a cow to the ground, the pack will "kind of pick around a little bit, eat the good stuff" — particularly the rectum and udders — "and then just leave them and go on to the next one," Torres said.

That's how he has found dozens of mortally injured young cows, trembling and in shock, after wolf attacks. "It's crazy, the endurance of these animals. They'll just take it," Torres said.

There's no saving them. Their intestines often spill out through their hindquarters, and Torres shoots the cows to put them out of their misery.

[See Wolves, A6]

Pardoned rioters see political prospects

Some are embraced as heroes and candidates for office after being convicted in Jan. 6 storming of Capitol.

By Ali Swenson

JACKSON, Mich. — Ryan Kelley thought he had a good shot at becoming Michigan's governor in 2022.

That is, until he was charged with and eventually convicted of misdemeanors related to his role in the Jan. 6 riot and insurrection at the U.S. Capitol. His campaign sputtered and he finished fourth out of five candidates in the Republican primary.

Three years later, Kelley says, people ask him all the time to run for governor again. In today's America, where President Trump returned to the White House and within hours pardoned some 1,500 Jan. 6 convicts, Kelley's two-month prison sentence for his actions that winter day in 2021 isn't the obstacle to public life it might once have been.

It may even be a ticket to political prominence.

Far from being sidelined, those who rioted, assaulted police officers or broke into congressional offices during the deadly attack — while trying to overturn Trump's loss in the 2020 presidential election — are now being

[See Rioters, A9]

Fire victims allege insurer collusion

Suits say firms pushed homeowners to a state plan that charged more, covered less.

By Karla Marie Sanford

A group of property owners affected by the January wildfires is suing major California insurance carriers, including the state's largest,

State Farm, accusing them of violating California's antitrust and unfair competition laws.

The lawsuits follow others regarding insurers' handling of the aftermath of the Eaton and Palisades fires, including against Insurance Commissioner Ricardo Lara and the California FAIR Plan (specifically about smoke damage), the state's beleaguered insurance plan of last resort.

The group complaint and

demand for jury trial filed Saturday in Los Angeles County Superior Court allege that in a "nefarious conspiracy," major insurers conspired to "eliminate competition between them," thereby "intentionally and systematically" forcing homeowners to accept the California FAIR Plan.

On the same day, lawyers filed a separate class-action lawsuit alleging the same thing.

"Insurance is a product

that homeowners hope never to need, but rely on for peace of mind in normal times and for critical help rebuilding after a catastrophe," Michael J. Bidart of Shernoff Bidart Echeverria, one of the law firms representing the plaintiffs, said in a statement. "The complaints allege that, by colluding to push plaintiffs and so many like them to the FAIR Plan, the defendants have reaped the benefits of high

[See Insurers, A8]

Trade war's unexpected export: Humor

What do penguins, the Chinese government and remote islands have in common? Tariff jokes.

By Hailey Branson-Potts



WOODEN dolls for sale in St. Petersburg, Russia, depict world leaders Xi, left, Trump and Putin.

One meme shows a red MAGA hat on a store shelf bearing a "Made in China" tag. The \$50 price is crossed out, replaced by a tariff-inflated cost of \$77.

Another cartoon — labeled "The Art of the Deal" after Trump's 1987 book — shows a pair of gambler's hands. One with the word "tariffs" on its suit sleeve draws from a deck of cards bearing percentages. The Embassy's caption: "But... the cards are made in #China. #Tariffwar."

In Canada, the premier of Manitoba, Wab Kinew, signed a decree in an oversized folder and held it up with his signature, à la Trump. "This order," he said, "it's a wonderful order. It's a beautiful order. This order is pulling American booze off the liquor mart shelves."

And on Norfolk Island — a remote rock in the Pacific Ocean with about 2,000 residents and essentially no ex-

[See Humor, A7]

Bass weighs layoffs, other cost cuts

Mayor's budget, to be released on Monday, may include shedding more than 1,500 jobs amid fiscal shortfall.

By David Zahniser and Julia Wick

For Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass, the list of problems keeps piling up.

She began the year facing a barrage of criticism over the city's handling of the Palisades fire — her initial absence, her removal of an outspoken fire chief, the unpredictable doings of her recovery czar.

But even without that devastating emergency, there are other signs that the city has entered a precarious period.

Construction of new homes has steadily slowed, even as housing costs climb. Film and television productions have been fleeing the city, wounding an entertainment industry already in crisis. President Trump's trade war and immigration crackdown threaten two other pillars of the economy: international trade and tourism.

On Monday, Bass will offer her assessment of the city's overall health during her yearly State of the City address. That same day, she will release her budget for 2025-26, laying out her plan for addressing yet another huge problem: the city's financial crisis.

Faced with a nearly \$1-billion shortfall, Bass has been weighing whether to lay off more than 1,500 city workers — or almost 5% of the workforce — while also eliminating some vacant positions. Those behind-the-scenes deliberations have left many at City Hall anxious about the potential impact on street repairs, street lighting, animal shelters and public safety programs.

City Councilmember Ysabel Jurado, who took office in December representing part of the Eastside, said she has been taken aback by the magnitude of the challenges.

"I knew our city services were broken. I knew we were

[See Budget, A8]

Sharp dissent on Supreme Court

Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. castigates majority in a ruling on Venezuelan deportations. **NATION, A4**

Hollywood faces tariff trouble

Global strife and a wobbly economy will hurt an already struggling entertainment industry. **BUSINESS, A12**

Mayor wants homeless 'purge'

The comments by Lancaster leader Rex Parris stir furor, with some foes seeking his recall. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Mostly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 72/54. **B5**

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